

UNADDRESSED EMPTINESS

ESSAY

David Alonso Diaz Giraldo

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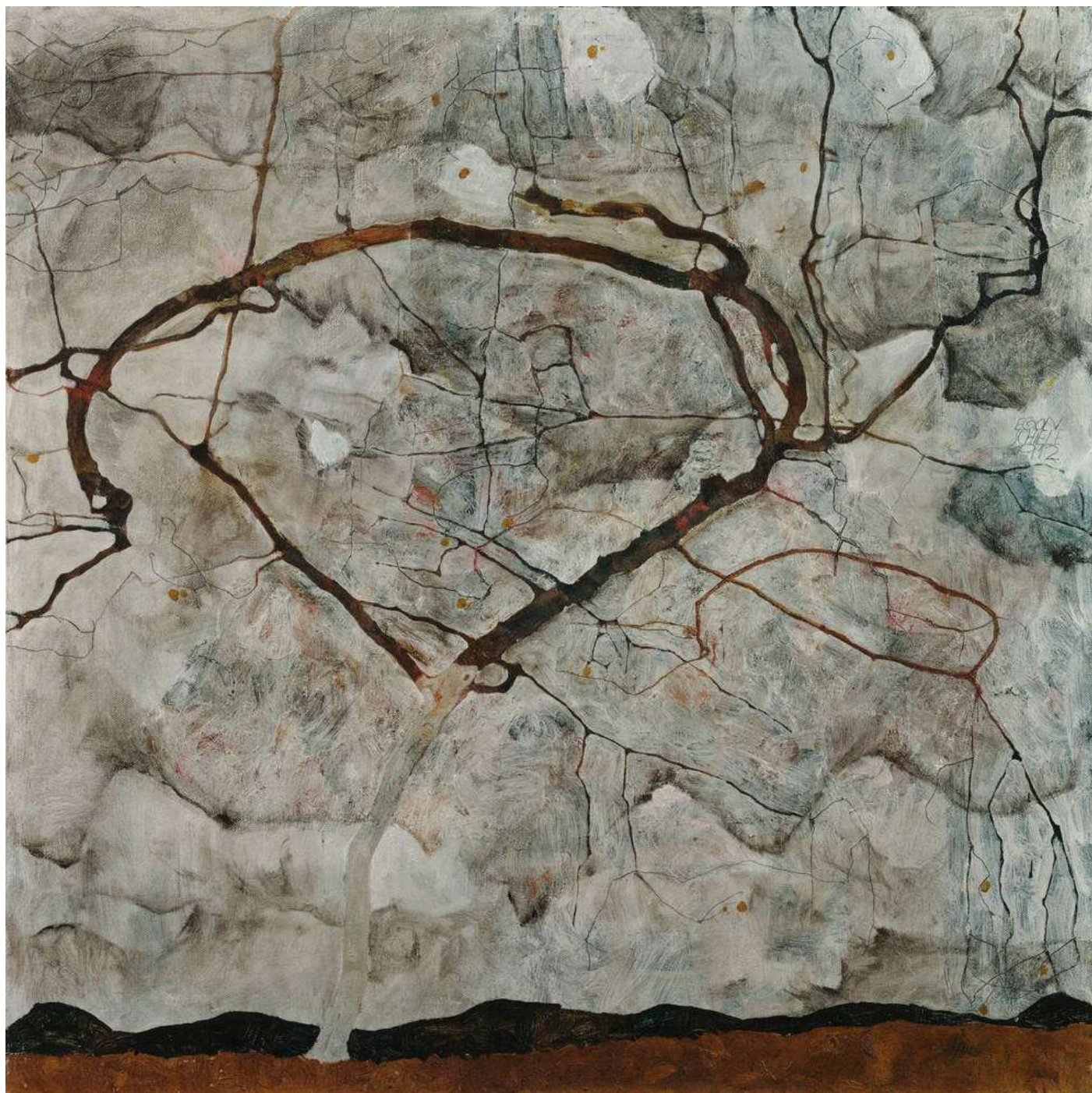












Disarcionamento di Bernardino della Carda

Paolo Uccello, 1456

Page 2 and 3

Caccia notturna

Paolo Uccello, 1470

Page 4 and 5

Schlacht bei Issus

Albrecht Altdorfer, 1528

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Herbstbaum in bewegter luft

Egon Schiele, 1912

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The invention of perspective was not transparency as a property of an object, it was the radical distinction of an object onto which sight could not accumulate. Emptiness becomes ever more present, no longer as a representation. Perspective distance is namely a substantiation of an unaddressed emptiness.

In *Disarcionamento di Bernardino della Carda* the main narrative event is also an application of the perspective model. Becoming ***perspective in action*** any heavy cavalry lance can determine a line that describes a unique vanishing point coinciding with the reloading crossbowman at the upper stripe of the painting. The central arc of dismounting a cavalryman constructively sets the scaffolding of perspective distance.

Simultaneously, the moving lance introduces the controversy of diagonal lines, which in the lower strip

are substituted by projected lines on a perpendicular grid once the perspective model incorporates them as vanishing straight lines. The argument on ambiguity is the set of diagonals outlining the fields, they converge to a central point and in doing so render the constitutive elements of perspective into the model of superimposition. Also, the ambiguity is thematized on a different narrative arc, that of the hunt: a chasing dog and fleeing hares between plowed grids loosely patched together.

Insofar as an unresolved narrative describes time, perspective is characterized as an ongoing action where the fallen horses and soldiers in the lower strip of the painting augment the detail on sections of the otherwise coarser grid of shattered lances, contrasting with the figures on the waving cloud of fields. Perspective is ambiguously replaced with superimposition at the level of the cavalrymen's heads clashing in the foreground and of the crossbows held above them. However, the explanatory distance between the legs of the horses occurs ***in contact with***

a representation, tightly framing an object, inventing a place for sight. As a generalization, it characterizes the unaddressed emptiness.

Instead of a narrative argument *Caccia notturna* incorporates the cube as a **subjunctive instrument** of the image, one to traverse the unaddressed emptiness with, which in a single action is being described and becoming descriptive. The layout of parametric trees with invariant height sets up a coordinate system where the morphing cube is a defining action of a **coordinated unaddressed emptiness**, unobtrusively lifting the ground.

The collapse of the unaddressed emptiness is equivalently a characterization of the horizon line, from which the sky is realized as an unattainable object, one unable to be described given the framework of relative distances, subsequently emphasizing a fundamental characteristic of the perspective image: the reciprocity of the unaddressed emptiness and representations, since every representation has to be in contact with the unaddressed emptiness.

For *Schlacht bei Issus* the middle stripe is a map including the Mediterranean island of Cyprus and the Nile delta, a map whose elements are not in contact with the unaddressed emptiness. Moreover, the horizon line is a representation rather than the collapse of the unaddressed emptiness. Such a shift constitutes a rupture describing the tension of perspective and superimposition images.

In *Herbstbaum in bewegter Luft* the relation between the ground, mountains and tree trunk characterize a superimposition image. However, the sky asserts its relation as background and as foreground, being ***pushed forward*** as far as the mesh of branches, to the extend of evaluating the transversal interplay of being against mediating figuration. The push forward happens as a ***carving out*** of detail in the figure, acting on a displacement in the notion of detail: from a representational value in figuration to a dense pictorial matter constitutive of the sky.

Readings

Susan Sontag, *Against Interpretation and Other Essays*, Against Interpretation, 1966

Dan Zahavi, *Phenomenology: The Basics*,
2.Intentionality, 2019

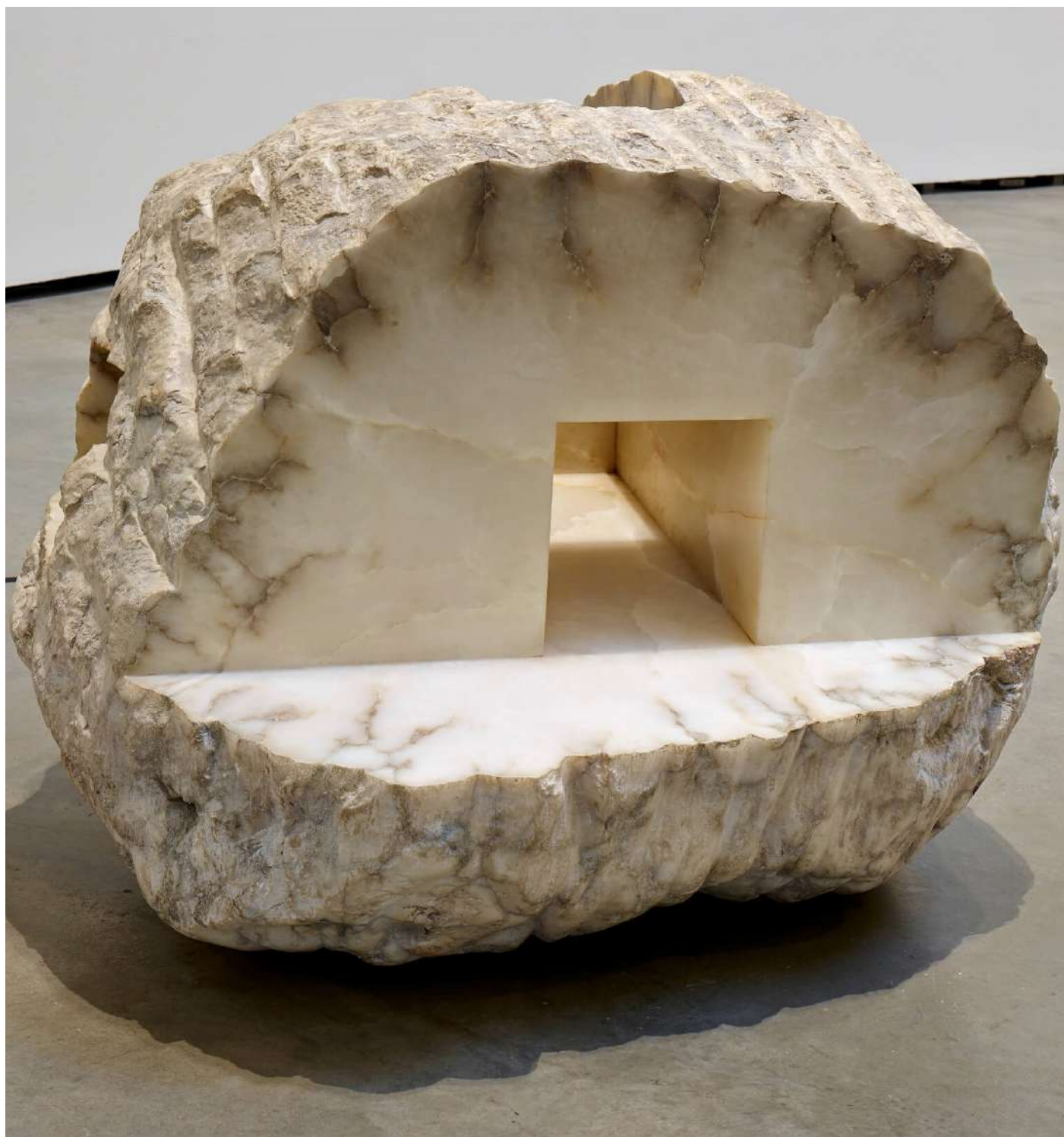
Georges Didi-Huberman, *The Cube and the Face*,
Face of Shadow and Spacing, 1993

Georges Didi-Huberman, *Fra Angelico*, 1990

On the materiality of the unaddressed emptiness

Annex

Lo profundo es el aire incorporates alabaster as the material of what is seen, of what is hidden and of what is absent. Form becomes derivative once what is absent and what is hidden have a material principle. As such the sculpture fixes a form and air is incorporated as ***the material of what is derivative***. However air is neither an emptiness nor is it unaddressed since it is occupied by the absent alabaster and framed by a suggested overall shape.



Lo profundo es el aire
Eduardo Chillida, 1996

On the subjunctive cube

Annex

Instead of the human body as a geometric synthesis the cube is ***the place of*** the torso and thighs in the posture, of the offering and name in the inscription. It embodies the place of images.



Early Block Statue Hotep

ca. 1900 BC

On the push forward

Annex

The virgin is a ***diagram*** with a mantle like arrows from her tilted head to her naked hands. Each node distinguishes space, which enables either superimposition or simultaneousness between nodes: their heads and part of her mantle share a plane. Arrows on the contrary don't distinguish space. However, a node can associate them with a plane: his hands ***push*** her mantle ***into*** their same plane, and likewise, his tunic slips through her fingers.



Madonna col Bambino
Simone Martini, ca. 1326

THE END